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Digital Discoveries introduces students to computer science as a vehicle for problem-solving, communication, and personal expression. The course focuses on the visible aspects of computing and computer science. It encourages students to see where computer science exists around them and how they can engage with it as a tool for exploration and expression.

In Grade 6 Digital Discoveries, instructional time will emphasize the following areas:

Active learning experiences are relevant to students' lives, and provide students with authentic choice. Students are encouraged to be curious, solve personally relevant problems and express themselves through creation. Learning is an inherently social activity, so the course is designed to interweave lessons with discussions, presentations, peer feedback, and shared reflections. As students proceed through the pathway, the structures increasingly shift responsibility to students to formulate their own questions, develop their own solutions, and critique their work.

It is also critical to diversify the technological workforce. Addressing inequities in computer science is critical to bringing it to all students. The tools and strategies in this course will help teachers understand and address well-known equity gaps within the field. All students can succeed in computer science when given the right support and opportunities, regardless of prior knowledge

M/J Grade 6 Digital Discoveries (#0200021)

Version: 2025 - And Beyond (current)

Course Standards

Visit the specific benchmark webpage to find related instructional resources.

- [SC.6.CC.1.1](#): Demonstrate an ability to communicate through various online tools.
- [SC.6.CC.2.1](#): Create a digital product individually and collaboratively.

Clarifications:

Clarification 1: When creating a product, students should be able to design and publish the product.

Clarification 2: Products include those that can inform, persuade or entertain.

- [SC.6.CO.1.1](#): Identify multiple file format types.

Clarifications:

Clarification 1: Within this benchmark, file types include formats for word processing, images, music and three-dimensional drawings.

Clarification 2: Instruction includes explaining why different file types exist.

- [SC.6.CO.1.2](#): Identify applications that have different desktop and online versions.

Clarifications:

Clarification 1: Instruction includes desktop versions and online subscription services.

- [SC.6.CS.1.1](#): Define the states of data.

Clarifications:

Clarification 1: States of data include data at rest, data in motion and data in use.

- [SC.6.CS.1.2](#): Illustrate the concept of access control and how to limit access to authorized users.
- [SC.6.CS.1.3](#): Discuss the importance of cybersecurity.

- [SC.6.CS.1.4:](#) Determine information that should remain confidential.
- [SC.6.CS.1.5:](#) Identify the need for encryption.
- [SC.6.CS.1.6:](#) Recognize the importance of digital identity.
- [SC.6.CS.2.1:](#) Identify the need for security safeguards on personal devices.
- [SC.6.ET.1.1:](#) Identify technology used to support specialized forms of human- computer interaction (HCI).

Clarifications:

Clarification 1: Technologies may include augmented reality (AR), virtual reality (VR) and others.

- [SC.6.ET.1.2:](#) Identify technology skills needed in the workplace.
- [SC.6.ET.2.1:](#) Identify the characteristics of Artificial Intelligence (AI).
- [SC.6.ET.2.2:](#) Discuss the benefits associated with Artificial Intelligence (AI).
- [SC.6.ET.3.2:](#) Describe how humans and machines interact to accomplish tasks that neither can accomplish alone.
- [SC.6.HS.1.1:](#) Identify the connection between strong passwords and Internet safety.
- [SC.6.HS.1.2:](#) Discuss the need for downloads to come from trusted sources.

Clarifications:

Clarification 1: Instruction focuses on a source's legitimacy.

- [SC.6.HS.1.4:](#) Evaluate a given website to determine if it is safe for users.

Clarifications:

Clarification 1: Instruction includes discussing the accuracy and security of given websites.

Clarification 2: Instruction includes types of personal information required for access and whether it is encrypted (https).

- [SC.6.HS.2.2:](#) List negative impacts of excessive device usage.

Clarifications:

Clarification 1: Instruction includes device addiction, online versus in-person personality traits, digital overload and others.

- [SC.6.PE.1.1:](#) Identify the types of operations that can be performed on different data types.

Clarifications:

Clarification 1: Operations include arithmetic operations and logical operations.

- [SC.6.PE.1.2:](#) Develop a program using a string data type.
- [SC.6.PE.1.3:](#) Develop a program using a numeric data type.

Clarifications:

Clarification 1: Instruction includes integers and floats.

- [SC.6.PE.1.4:](#) Index selected items within a list.

Clarifications:

Clarification 1: Instruction includes indexing items from a list in a spreadsheet, array list or programming language.

- [SC.6.PE.1.7:](#) Write code segments that use standard mathematical operators.

Clarifications:

Clarification 1: Instruction includes the use of addition, subtraction, multiplication and division.

Clarification 2: Within this benchmark, instruction includes the use of inequalities.

- [SC.6.PE.1.8:](#) Use a function for a specified purpose.

Clarifications:

Clarification 1: Within this benchmark, the term function and procedure can be used interchangeably.

Clarification 2: Instruction includes consideration of the intake and output of information.

- [SC.6.PE.1.9:](#) Use looping techniques for a specified purpose.

Clarifications:

Clarification 1: Within this benchmark, the terms iteration and loop will be used interchangeably.

- [SC.6.PE.1.10:](#) Use conditional statements for a specified purpose.

Clarifications:

Clarification 1: Within this benchmark, the term selection and conditional statement will be used interchangeably.

- [SC.6.PE.1.11](#): Design solutions that use repetition and two-way selection.

Clarifications:

Clarification 1: Within this benchmark two-way selections include while, for and if/else statements.

- [SC.6.PE.2.1](#): Create designated graph types using data.

Clarifications:

Clarification 1: Graph types include graphs, charts, tables and Venn diagram.

- [SC.6.PE.3.1](#): Identify what kinds of real-world problems can be solved using modeling and simulation.
- [SC.6.PE.3.2](#): Interact with content-specific models and simulations to support learning, research and problem-solving.
- [SC.6.PE.3.3](#): Design a digital model.
- [SC.6.PE.3.5](#): Create a visual representation of a solution to a problem.

Clarifications:

Clarification 1: Instruction includes visually writing out a program plan.

- [SC.6.PE.3.6](#): Evaluate the logical flow of a step-by-step program by acting it out through computer-free activities.

Clarifications:

Clarification 1: Instruction includes drafting a flowchart.

- [SC.6.PE.4.1](#): Recognize the phases of the software development life cycle.
- [SC.6.TI.1.1](#): Recognize the data content sources that make your digital footprint.

Clarifications:

Clarification 1: Instruction includes permanence of digital footprint.

Clarification 2: Within this benchmark, digital footprint includes digital profiles and other forms of personally identifiable information (PII).

- [SC.6.TI.1.2](#): Explore the history of computer and other devices.

Clarifications:

Clarification 1: Instruction includes legacy devices and antiquated technology.

- [SC.6.TI.1.4:](#) Describe various technology-related career paths.
- [SC.6.TI.2.1:](#) Recognize the consequences of plagiarism on the development of creative works.

Clarifications:

Clarification 1: Creative works include projects, publications and online content.

Clarification 2: Instruction includes defining intellectual property.

- [SC.6.TI.2.2:](#) Demonstrate compliance with the school's Acceptable Use Policy.
- [SC.6.TI.2.3:](#) Explain fair use for using copyrighted materials.

Clarifications:

Clarification 1: Copyrighted materials include images, music, video and text.

- [SC.K12.CTR.1.1:](#) **Actively participate in effortful learning both individually and collaboratively.**
Students who actively participate in effortful learning both individually and with others:
 - Build perseverance by modifying methods as needed while solving a challenging task.
 - Stay engaged and maintain a positive mindset when working to solve tasks.
 - Help and support each other when attempting a new method or approach.

Clarifications:

Teachers who encourage students to participate actively in effortful learning both individually and with others:

- Cultivate a community of learners.
- Foster perseverance in students by choosing challenging tasks.
- Recognize students' effort when solving challenging problems.
- Emphasize project-based learning.
- Establish a culture in which students ask questions of the teacher and their peers, and errors as a learning opportunity.

- Develop students' ability to justify methods and compare their responses to the responses of their peers.

- **SC.K12.CTR.2.1: Demonstrate understanding by decomposing a problem.**

Students who demonstrate understanding by decomposing a problem:

- Analyze the problems in a way that makes sense given the task.
- Ask questions that will help with solving the task.
- Break down complex problems into individual problems.
- Decompose a complex problem into manageable parts.

Clarifications:

Teachers who encourage students to demonstrate understanding by decomposing a problem:

- Develop students' ability to analyze and problem-solve.
- Help students break complex tasks into subtasks.
- Show students that the solution to individual parts allows them to solve complex problems more effectively.

- **SC.K12.CTR.3.1:**

Complete tasks with digital fluency.

Students who complete tasks with digital fluency: Select and use appropriate digital tools by their functions.

- Demonstrate proper typing techniques and keyboarding skills.
- Understand responsible technology use.
- Use feedback to improve efficiency using digital tools.
- Relate previously learned concepts to new concepts.
- Solve problems by developing, testing and refining technological processes.

Clarifications:

Teachers who encourage students to complete tasks with digital fluency:

- Provide students with opportunities to increase critical thinking skills.

- Provide students with opportunities to use various technology hardware and software, so that technology is an integral part of the learning experience. Develop students' ability to construct relationships between their current understanding and more sophisticated ways of thinking.

- SC.K12.CTR.4.1:

Express solutions as computational steps.

Students who express solutions as computational steps:

- Solve problems step by step rather than all at once.
- Represent solutions to problems in multiple ways, based on context or purpose.
- Use patterns and structures to understand and connect computational concepts.
- Check computations when solving problems.

Clarifications:

Teachers who encourage students to express solutions as computational steps:

- Provide opportunities for students to develop sequentially based understandings of problems.
- Guide students to align tasks to a step-by-step solution.
- Select sequence and present student work to advance and deepen understanding of correct and increasingly efficient methods.
- Prompt students to continually ask, "Does this solution make sense? How do you know?"
- Reinforce that students check their work as they progress within and after a task.
- Strengthen students' ability to verify solutions through justification.

- SC.K12.CTR.5.1:

Create an algorithm to achieve a given goal.

Students who create algorithms to achieve a given goal:

- Create or use a well-defined series of steps to achieve a desired outcome.
- Compare the efficiency of an algorithm to those expressed by others.

- Design a sequence of steps to follow.
- Verify possible solutions by explaining the program or methods used.

Clarifications:

Teachers who encourage students to create an algorithm to achieve a given goal:

- Support students to develop generalizations based on the similarities found among problems.
- Have students estimate or predict solutions before solving.
- Help students recognize the patterns in the world around them and connect these patterns to other concepts.

• SC.K12.CTR.6.1:

Differentiate between usable data and miscellaneous information.

Students who differentiate between usable data and miscellaneous information:

- Express connections between concepts and representations.
- Construct possible arguments based on evidence.
- Perform decision-making between two actions.
- Practice evaluating information and sources.
- Perform investigations to gather data or determine if a program or method is appropriate.
- Discern relevant, meaningful data from irrelevant or extraneous information.
- Understand the characteristics and criteria determining whether data is relevant to a specific problem or task.

Clarifications:

Teachers who encourage students to differentiate between useable data and miscellaneous information:

- Support students as they validate conclusions by comparing them to the given situation.
- Create opportunities for students to discuss their thinking with peers.

• SC.K12.CTR.7.1:

Solve real-life problems in science and engineering using computational thinking.

Students who solve real-life problems in science and engineering using computational thinking:

- Adapt procedures to find solutions and apply them to a new context.
- Look for similarities among problems.
- Connect solutions of problems to more complicated large-scale situations.
- Connect concepts to everyday experiences.
- Use programs, models and methods to understand, represent and solve problems.
- Indicate how various concepts can be applied to other disciplines.
- Redesign programs, models and methods to improve accuracy or efficiency. Evaluate results based on the given context.

Clarifications:

Teachers who encourage students to solve real-life problems in science and engineering using computational thinking:

- Create learning opportunities that require logical reasoning and problem-solving skills.
- Provide opportunities for students to create plans and procedures to solve problems.
- Provide opportunities for students to create programs or models, both concrete and abstract, and perform investigations.
- Challenge students to question the accuracy of their programs, models and methods.

- **MA.K12.MTR.1.1: Actively participate in effortful learning both individually and collectively.**

Mathematicians who participate in effortful learning both individually and with others:

- Analyze the problem in a way that makes sense given the task.
- Ask questions that will help with solving the task.
- Build perseverance by modifying methods as needed while solving a challenging task.

- Stay engaged and maintain a positive mindset when working to solve tasks.
- Help and support each other when attempting a new method or approach.

Clarifications:

Teachers who encourage students to participate actively in effortful learning both individually and with others:

- Cultivate a community of growth mindset learners.
- Foster perseverance in students by choosing tasks that are challenging.
- Develop students' ability to analyze and problem solve.
- Recognize students' effort when solving challenging problems.

• **MA.K12.MTR.2.1: Demonstrate understanding by representing problems in multiple ways.**

Mathematicians who demonstrate understanding by representing problems in multiple ways:

- Build understanding through modeling and using manipulatives.
- Represent solutions to problems in multiple ways using objects, drawings, tables, graphs and equations.
- Progress from modeling problems with objects and drawings to using algorithms and equations.
- Express connections between concepts and representations.
- Choose a representation based on the given context or purpose.

Clarifications:

Teachers who encourage students to demonstrate understanding by representing problems in multiple ways:

- Help students make connections between concepts and representations.
- Provide opportunities for students to use manipulatives when investigating concepts.
- Guide students from concrete to pictorial to abstract representations as understanding progresses.

- Show students that various representations can have different purposes and can be useful in different situations.

- **MA.K12.MTR.3.1: Complete tasks with mathematical fluency.**

Mathematicians who complete tasks with mathematical fluency:

- Select efficient and appropriate methods for solving problems within the given context.
- Maintain flexibility and accuracy while performing procedures and mental calculations.
- Complete tasks accurately and with confidence.
- Adapt procedures to apply them to a new context.
- Use feedback to improve efficiency when performing calculations.

Clarifications:

Teachers who encourage students to complete tasks with mathematical fluency:

- Provide students with the flexibility to solve problems by selecting a procedure that allows them to solve efficiently and accurately.
- Offer multiple opportunities for students to practice efficient and generalizable methods.
- Provide opportunities for students to reflect on the method they used and determine if a more efficient method could have been used.

- **MA.K12.MTR.4.1: Engage in discussions that reflect on the mathematical thinking of self and others.**

Mathematicians who engage in discussions that reflect on the mathematical thinking of self and others:

- Communicate mathematical ideas, vocabulary and methods effectively.
- Analyze the mathematical thinking of others.
- Compare the efficiency of a method to those expressed by others.
- Recognize errors and suggest how to correctly solve the task.
- Justify results by explaining methods and processes.
- Construct possible arguments based on evidence.

Clarifications:

Teachers who encourage students to engage in discussions that reflect on the mathematical thinking of self and others:

- Establish a culture in which students ask questions of the teacher and their peers, and error is an opportunity for learning.
 - Create opportunities for students to discuss their thinking with peers.
 - Select, sequence and present student work to advance and deepen understanding of correct and increasingly efficient methods.
 - Develop students' ability to justify methods and compare their responses to the responses of their peers.
- **MA.K12.MTR.5.1: Use patterns and structure to help understand and connect mathematical concepts.**

Mathematicians who use patterns and structure to help understand and connect mathematical concepts:

- Focus on relevant details within a problem.
- Create plans and procedures to logically order events, steps or ideas to solve problems.
- Decompose a complex problem into manageable parts.
- Relate previously learned concepts to new concepts.
- Look for similarities among problems.
- Connect solutions of problems to more complicated large-scale situations.

Clarifications:

Teachers who encourage students to use patterns and structure to help understand and connect mathematical concepts:

- Help students recognize the patterns in the world around them and connect these patterns to mathematical concepts.
- Support students to develop generalizations based on the similarities found among problems.
- Provide opportunities for students to create plans and procedures to solve problems.
- Develop students' ability to construct relationships between their current understanding and more sophisticated ways of thinking.

- **MA.K12.MTR.6.1: Assess the reasonableness of solutions.**

Mathematicians who assess the reasonableness of solutions:

- Estimate to discover possible solutions.
- Use benchmark quantities to determine if a solution makes sense.
- Check calculations when solving problems.
- Verify possible solutions by explaining the methods used.
- Evaluate results based on the given context.

Clarifications:

Teachers who encourage students to assess the reasonableness of solutions:

- Have students estimate or predict solutions prior to solving.
- Prompt students to continually ask, “Does this solution make sense? How do you know?”
- Reinforce that students check their work as they progress within and after a task.
- Strengthen students’ ability to verify solutions through justifications.

- **MA.K12.MTR.7.1: Apply mathematics to real-world contexts.**

Mathematicians who apply mathematics to real-world contexts:

- Connect mathematical concepts to everyday experiences.
- Use models and methods to understand, represent and solve problems.
- Perform investigations to gather data or determine if a method is appropriate.
- Redesign models and methods to improve accuracy or efficiency.

Clarifications:

Teachers who encourage students to apply mathematics to real-world contexts:

- Provide opportunities for students to create models, both concrete and abstract, and perform investigations.
- Challenge students to question the accuracy of their models and methods.

- Support students as they validate conclusions by comparing them to the given situation.
- Indicate how various concepts can be applied to other disciplines.
- [ELA.K12.EE.1.1](#): Cite evidence to explain and justify reasoning.

Clarifications:

K-1 Students include textual evidence in their oral communication with guidance and support from adults. The evidence can consist of details from the text without naming the text. During 1st grade, students learn how to incorporate the evidence in their writing.

2-3 Students include relevant textual evidence in their written and oral communication. Students should name the text when they refer to it. In 3rd grade, students should use a combination of direct and indirect citations.

4-5 Students continue with previous skills and reference comments made by speakers and peers. Students cite texts that they've directly quoted, paraphrased, or used for information. When writing, students will use the form of citation dictated by the instructor or the style guide referenced by the instructor.

6-8 Students continue with previous skills and use a style guide to create a proper citation.

9-12 Students continue with previous skills and should be aware of existing style guides and the ways in which they differ.

- [ELA.K12.EE.2.1](#): Read and comprehend grade-level complex texts proficiently.

Clarifications:

See [Text Complexity](#) for grade-level complexity bands and a text complexity rubric.

- [ELA.K12.EE.3.1](#): Make inferences to support comprehension.

Clarifications:

Students will make inferences before the words infer or inference are introduced. Kindergarten students will answer questions like "Why is the girl smiling?" or make predictions about what will happen based on the title page. Students will use the terms and apply them in 2nd grade and beyond.

- [ELA.K12.EE.4.1](#): Use appropriate collaborative techniques and active listening skills when engaging in discussions in a variety of situations.

Clarifications:

In kindergarten, students learn to listen to one another respectfully.

In grades 1-2, students build upon these skills by justifying what they are thinking. For example: “I think _____ because _____.” The collaborative conversations are becoming academic conversations.

In grades 3-12, students engage in academic conversations discussing claims and justifying their reasoning, refining and applying skills. Students build on ideas, propel the conversation, and support claims and counterclaims with evidence.

- [ELA.K12.EE.5.1](#): Use the accepted rules governing a specific format to create quality work.

Clarifications:

Students will incorporate skills learned into work products to produce quality work. For students to incorporate these skills appropriately, they must receive instruction. A 3rd grade student creating a poster board display must have instruction in how to effectively present information to do quality work.

- [ELA.K12.EE.6.1](#): Use appropriate voice and tone when speaking or writing.

Clarifications:

In kindergarten and 1st grade, students learn the difference between formal and informal language. For example, the way we talk to our friends differs from the way we speak to adults. In 2nd grade and beyond, students practice appropriate social and academic language to discuss texts.

- [ELD.K12.ELL.MA.1](#): English language learners communicate information, ideas and concepts necessary for academic success in the content area of Mathematics.

Course Information

General Notes

This course should be taught using Florida's State Academic Standards for Computer Science: Florida's B.E.S.T. ELA Expectations (EE), Mathematical Thinking and Reasoning Standards (MTRs) and Computational Thinking and Reasoning Standards (CTRs) for students. Florida educators should intentionally embed these standards within the content and their instruction as applicable.

English Language Development ELD Standards Special Notes Section

Teachers are required to provide listening, speaking, reading and writing instruction that allows English language learners (ELL) to communicate information, ideas and concepts for academic success in the content area of Mathematics. For the given level of English language proficiency and with visual, graphic, or interactive support, students will interact with grade level words, expressions, sentences and discourse to process or produce language necessary for academic success. The ELD standard should specify a relevant content area concept or topic of study chosen by curriculum developers and teachers which maximizes an ELL's need for communication and social skills. To access an ELL supporting document which delineates performance definitions and descriptors, please click on the following link: <https://cpalmsmediaproduct.blob.core.windows.net/uploads/docs/standards/eld/si.pdf>.

Accommodations

Federal and state legislation requires the provision of accommodations for students with disabilities as identified on the secondary student's Individual Educational Plan (IEP) or 504 plan or postsecondary student's accommodations' plan to meet individual needs and ensure equal access. Accommodations change the way the student is instructed. Students with disabilities may need accommodations in such areas as instructional methods and materials, assignments and assessments, time demands and schedules, learning environment, assistive technology and special communication systems. Documentation of the accommodations requested and provided should be maintained in a confidential file.

In addition to accommodations, some secondary students with disabilities (students with an IEP served in Exceptional Student Education (ESE)) will need modifications to meet their needs. Modifications change the outcomes and or what the student is expected to learn, e.g., modifying the curriculum of a secondary career and technical education course.

General Information

Course Number: 0200021

Course Path: **Section:** Grades PreK to 12 Education Courses >

Grade Group: Grades 6 to 8 Education Courses > **Subject:**

Computer Science > **SubSubject:** General >

Abbreviated Title: M/J GR6 DIG DISC

Course Length: Semester (S)

Course Type: Elective Course

Course Level: 2

Course Status: Course Approved

Educator Certifications

One of these educator certification options is required to teach this course.

- [Computer Science \(Elementary and Secondary Grades K-12\)](#)

Section 1012.55(5), F.S., authorizes the issuance of a classical education teaching certificate, upon the request of a classical school, to any applicant who fulfills the requirements of s. 1012.56(2)(a)-(f) and (11), F.S., and Rule 6A-4.004, F.A.C. Classical schools must meet the requirements outlined in s. 1012.55(5), F.S., and be listed in the [FLDOE Master School ID](#) database, to request a restricted classical education teaching certificate on behalf of an applicant.

Qualifications

As well as any certification requirements listed on the course description, the following qualifications may also be acceptable for the course:

Any field when certification reflects a bachelor or higher degree.